

Braid

Save in circles. Know what's yours to spend.

A tester's guide — what it is, how each part works, and what to do over the next few weeks · Prepared 4 September 2026 · Questions: cdifeanyiokafor@gmail.com

Braid is a money app built for how Nigerians actually save and spend — personal budgeting plus **savings-club circles** that sync live between everyone in them, in one place. You're testing it before anyone outside this group sees it, so what you notice in the next few weeks directly shapes what ships next.

THE ONE IDEA WORTH UNDERSTANDING

Your bank balance is a lie — it includes money that's already spoken for. Braid's home screen shows one number instead: **Safe to Spend**. It's your liquid balance, minus bills due before your next income, minus circle contributions due this period, minus what your goals need, minus a small buffer for how bumpy your spending usually is. Every other screen exists to feed that number.

IMPORTANT — THIS IS A TEST BUILD

No real money moves anywhere in Braid right now. Circle contributions, investments and payouts are all **recorded**, not transferred — think of it as a shared ledger, not a bank. Identity verification (BVN / NIN / selfie) is a demo toggle with no real check behind it. Expect bugs — finding them is the point.

Getting set up — five minutes

Before you start

- Open the link on your phone and add it to your home screen (Safari > Share > Add to Home Screen, or Chrome's menu button > Add to Home screen).
- Enter your name and email — you'll get a **6-digit code** by email, then enter it. No password.
- Add the accounts and wallets you actually use, with real current balances.
- Tell it how your income arrives — salaried, irregular, or mixed — and which day it lands.
- You'll land on your Safe to Spend home screen. That's it — you're in.

The features

What each tab does, and how to use it

There are five tabs — Home, Circles, Discover, Grow, You — plus a floating + to start a circle, and Ask Braid, the assistant, reachable from Home or You.

Home — Safe to Spend

The number itself, and everything subtracted to get there. Tap any line in the breakdown — bills, circle contributions, goal accruals, the volatility buffer — to see exactly what's in it. If a bill falls just after your next payday, it still shows here, greyed, so it's never simply invisible.

Below the number, Braid nudges you in plain language, and if you're short, it offers up to three concrete ways back — never just a red number and silence.

HOW TO USE IT

- Tap the **Safe to Spend** figure or any breakdown row to expand it.
- If a circle contribution is due soon and your balance may not cover it, a gold card tells you before you miss it — tap it to open that circle.
- "Your circles this cycle" cards let you pay a contribution in one tap without leaving Home.

02

Money — logging what you spend

This is how Braid learns your real pattern. The faster and more honestly you log, the more useful your Safe to Spend number gets.

Four ways in: paste a bank debit alert as text, import a CSV bank statement, type an entry by hand, or let a recurring bill auto-detect itself after it repeats a few times.

HOW TO USE IT

- **Money > Paste an alert** — copy the SMS/email debit alert your bank sent you and paste it in. Braid reads the amount, guesses a category, and flags anything it couldn't read or that looks like a duplicate — check both before confirming.
- **Money > Import statement** — pick a CSV export from your bank or wallet app; map the date/amount/description columns once.
- **Obligations** (bottom of Money) — add a recurring bill directly: rent, dues, a subscription, money sent home. Toggle **auto** and it posts itself on the due date every cycle.
- When logging a transfer to a person, tick "**this went to a person**" — and if it repeats monthly, tick that too so it becomes a tracked obligation immediately instead of waiting to repeat.

Foreign-currency alerts (USD, GBP...) are deliberately not captured — Braid only reads naira, so add those by hand.

03

Circles — your savings clubs and family funds

A circle is a savings group that lives inside Braid instead of a WhatsApp chat and a notebook. Everyone in it sees the same roster, the same ledger, and the same rotation — in real time.

Four types: **Rotating** (the classic savings club — the pot goes to a different member each cycle), **Target** (everyone saves toward one date, then withdraws together), **One-off** (a single collection for a wedding, burial or medical bill — pay once, the organiser disburses it, done), and **Family**.

HOW TO USE IT

- Tap **+** to create one — a 3-step wizard covers the basics, the payout order, and a review before it goes live.
- Share the 6-letter code it gives you. Others tap **Circles > Find**, enter the code, and they're in.
- Pay your contribution from the circle's page, or straight from its card on Home.
- If money doesn't arrive when it should, open the circle and raise a **Dispute** — payouts pause 48h while the organiser resolves it.
- **Circle float vote** — members can vote to hold an idle pot in a simulated money-market fund between payouts. It's all-or-nothing: it only runs if every member agrees.

Your reliability score (visible on You and Circles) only starts counting once you've completed a cycle in a circle of 3+ real members — a lone or two-person circle can't mint a score.

04

Discover — circles beyond your own network

A marketplace of public circles you're not already in — trader cooperatives, rent circles, December savings funds — each showing its track record, guarantee fund and the reliability score needed to qualify.

HOW TO USE IT

- Filter by category, or scroll to see what's open.
- Tap a circle to see its full terms — pot size, payout order, guarantee fund, organiser stake.
- If you qualify, request to join; the organiser reviews it. If you don't yet, it tells you exactly what score you'd need.

05

Grow — simulated investing

A place to put idle money to work — naira money-market funds, dollar-denominated options, and a small, capped crypto sleeve — each labelled with its real risk, return basis and liquidity. Nothing here is real money yet; it's a preview of where Braid is headed.

HOW TO USE IT

- Grow shows your **idle balance** — what's left after Safe to Spend and existing positions.
- Tap a product to see the honest version of its risk, then move a simulated amount in.
- Circle organisers can also see the float — the idle pot earning simulated yield between payouts — here.

06

You — your reliability, identity and settings

Your reputation, portable across every circle you join, plus shortcuts to everything about your money and account.

HOW TO USE IT

- The ring at the top is your **reliability score** — on-time contributions across real circles. New accounts show "unrated" until they've earned one.
 - **Identity** — BVN / NIN / phone verification are demo toggles in this build, clearly labelled; nothing real is checked yet.
 - **Your money** — jump straight to spending & obligations, goals, or Ask Braid.
 - The gear icon opens Settings — your income assumptions, rent, the volatility buffer, and your linked accounts.
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07

Ask Braid — the guardrailed assistant

A money assistant with one hard rule: it can only narrate numbers Braid's own engine has already computed. It cannot invent a figure, and it will say so rather than guess.

It can explain your Safe to Spend down to the naira, answer questions about a specific category, bill or circle, build a savings plan for a goal (and hand you a one-tap button to create it), or work out what a lump sum compounds to at a rate you give it. It will not tell you where to invest — it isn't a licensed adviser, and it says that plainly too.

HOW TO USE IT

- Open it from Home (**Ask Braid**) or You.
 - Ask in plain words — Nigerian English or Pidgin both work. Try: *"why is my safe-to-spend where it is?"* or *"how do I save ₦500,000 for December in 4 months?"*
 - If it suggests a goal, a gold button appears — tap it to create the goal pre-filled, nothing typed twice.
 - A short flagged note under an answer means it caught itself using a figure it couldn't verify, and showed you the engine's own read instead — that's the safety net working, not a bug.
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Feedback — the fastest way to reach me

Send it the moment something's off

There's a feedback button in three places — a quiet link at the bottom of Home, a row on the You tab, and inside Settings. Pick a face, add a note if you want, send. It reaches me directly with your name and which screen you were on.

Over the next few weeks

What I actually need from you

This only works if the numbers going in are real. A tidy demo account tells me nothing — your actual bills, your actual spending, your actual circle tell me everything.

Week one

- Set up properly — real accounts, real balances, your real payday.

- Add every recurring bill you can think of under Obligations: rent, dues, subscriptions, money you send home.
- Paste a bank alert every time you spend, or at least once a day. This is the habit that makes Safe to Spend trustworthy.
- Join the circle I share with you — pay your first contribution through the app, not around it.

Ongoing, every week

- Check Safe to Spend before you make a real spending decision — does it match your gut? Tell me the moment it doesn't.
- Ask Braid at least a couple of real questions — a planning one ("how do I save for X") and a factual one ("how much have I spent on Y").
- Try creating your own circle at least once — a one-off collection is the fastest to set up.
- Poke around Discover and Grow, even just to look.
- Send feedback for anything confusing, broken, ugly, or that genuinely delighted you — all four are useful.

A NOTE ON HONESTY

Braid is only as good as what you put into it. If a number looks wrong, don't quietly stop trusting it — tell me. A confusing screen, a bill that vanished, a circle that felt clunky to set up: all of that is exactly the signal I need before anyone else sees this.

Braid — working name, test build. Figures shown are yours, held in your own account; nothing here moves real money. Thank you for trying it.